

THE BOOTH

SINGLE SOURCE OF TRUTH

GUILTY / House of Guilty · theboothrecord.com · v1 · 2026-07-10 · Authored with Claude (strategy/flow/design layer). Code-level specifics marked [FROM REPO] must be filled from Claude Code / the codebase – not authored from memory.

1. What The Booth Is (purpose)

The Booth is a B2B proof engine wearing a consumer costume. A venue customer scans a QR, confesses a small transgression, and receives a deadpan AI "verdict" card branded GUILTY and stamped with the venue's name. The confessor is **not** the customer — the **venue** is.

Canonical definition (supersedes earlier "acquisition funnel" framing): The Booth is a **REACH / EXPERIENCE** play. The shareable verdict card IS the product. There is **NO capture, NO nurture** — email/contact capture was built, tested, and deliberately shelved (nobody enters an email mid-confession at a venue). This is not a gap; do not reopen it.

Firewall retired 27 Jun 2026 — GUILTY may appear on the Booth. The moderation layer (approve/reject before the public wall) is load-bearing since then.

2. Marketing purpose & the two benefits

The Booth gives a venue two independent benefits — one provable, one not:

- In-venue experience (provable):** each completed confession is a distinctive moment in the room that a plain soda can't create. Measurable — this is the primary metric.
- Branded reach (soft):** shared verdict cards carry the venue name beyond the room. Real but unmeasurable — share *intent* (tap) can be counted; actual reach cannot.

Pitch primacy: lead with engagement + branded content (the differentiator no other soda can show). Place a **reorder** alongside it as the commercial fact. **Never claim causation** — present engagement and reorders as two true facts side by side; let the operator connect them. "Drives engagement = more sales" is correlation, not causation.

3. The proof-engine loop

Cans in → in-venue confessions + branded cards out → proof → next venue → more cans in.

Each venue closed makes the next cheaper to close. Seoul Tiger = the **lab** (trusting partner; debug the mechanism, produce the first number, run the first on/off causal test). Frenchie = the **showroom** (high-social; generate the quotable number). The \$3 Frenchie price is bought by the Booth being live + content, not given as a discount.

4. Metrics

METRIC	WHAT IT PROVES	SOURCE / RULE
COMPLETED CONFESSIONS / VENUE (PRIMARY)	In-venue engagement + branded cards generated. The pitch number.	Count rows with non-null verdict, by exact source slug, excluding <code>direct</code> and <code>is_test</code> .
COMPLETION RATE (DIAGNOSTIC)	Experience quality (finishers ÷ scans)	Deferred — needs scan-arrival logging; not pitch-critical.
SHARE-TAP COUNT (SOFT)	Card was good enough to want to share (NOT reach)	<code>share_events</code> table; tap only, no dedup, no destination.
REORDER (COMMERCIAL)		

	Cans sold — the only number that pays the bills	Order history; placed alongside engagement, causation never claimed.
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Metric query: `select source, count(*) from public.confessions where verdict_text is not null and source <> 'direct' and is_test is not true group by source;`

Causation: a single venue's scans + reorders = correlation only. The only route to a causal claim is an **on/off test** (Booth on 2 wks → off 2 wks → watch reorders) — run at Seoul Tiger. Architectural honesty: the Booth is deliberately separated from the till (no capture), so it cannot directly attribute a sale to a scan.

5. Flow logic (guest journey)

Order is fixed. A QR scan enters at the **top** (consent gate), never mid-flow.

- 1. **Consent gate** — "Once you begin, you can't take it back." 18+ tick + ENTER. Required on **every** entry path including QR scans. Consent stored per-session (re-gates on a fresh visit; not on same-session repeat). Source + `?test=1` persist through the gate.
- 2. **Confess screen** — venue-tailored prompt (headline + optional guidance) keyed on `?source=`. Free-text confession + voice input. 18+/Terms line present.
- 3. **Loading** — three-beat green-mono sequence ("Your sin is being received." → "The booth is deciding." → "Your verdict is coming.") with blinking cursor on every line. Generation runs ~12-18s (avg 16s), non-streaming.
- 4. **Verdict card** — "THE BOOTH NOTICED." + confession + verdict + GUILTY oval + "AS CHARGED / AT [venue]" (or LOCATION WITHHELD).
- 5. **Share (ON RECORD)** — PRIMARY: single link `/v/{uuid}`, sent with generic CTA text "You've been summoned. You know what you did.", unfurling to a per-verdict OG card. SECONDARY: SAVE IMAGE (client PNG, for Stories). CONFESS AGAIN + THE PUBLIC RECORD also present.
- 6. **Public wall** (`/thewall`, "THE PUBLIC RECORD") — moderated; only approved confessions shown; carries the GUILTY wordmark; the page a venue customer lands on.

6. Visual / brand design

BOOTH APP AESTHETIC

Dark ground, warm cream/off-white body text, **green mono** (#3fb950-ish) for system/booth voice lines, **GUILTY orange #FF4800** for the oval mark. Söhne Mono for labels/system text, Control Upright Bold TNT for verdict headlines, sans for confession body.

VERDICT CARD

Header "THE BOOTH NOTICED." (green mono) · confession echo (mono) · verdict (Control Upright, dynamic sizing: 70px, stepping down on long verdicts so long roasts don't clip) · GUILTY orange oval (with TM on the client PNG; TM dropped on the Satori server render) · "AS CHARGED / AT [VENUE]" or "LOCATION WITHHELD" · SUBJECT #n · @houseofguilty.

VENUE TABLE CARDS (PER-VENUE, CO-BRANDED)

Type = who's speaking (GUILTY fonts: Control Upright headline + Söhne Mono labels). Colour = whose house you're in (the venue's palette). Print spec: **55 x 90mm portrait, single-face, 3mm bleed, CMYK, fonts embedded, square-cut, 300gsm silk**. QR: error-correction Q, baked white quiet-zone, on a cream/white panel; always physically test-scan before a batch.

VENUE	PALETTE	TABLE-CARD HEADLINE / PROMPT
SEOUL TIGER 1988	Bone #EFE7D6 / espresso #2E211A / gold #C8912F	"CONFESS YOUR MOST GUILTY ORDER." → prompt "Confess your most guilty order." / "The one you'd never admit to."
FRENCHIE (A)	Terracotta #A8402E / cream	"EVERYONE HERE IS GUILTY." → "Everyone here is guilty." / "Yours first."
FRENCHIE (B)	Terracotta / cream	

"WE ALREADY KNOW." → "We already know." / "Say it anyway."

[FROM REPO] Exact hex from physical venue assets (Seoul Tiger colours are approximated from screenshots); venue's real wordmark for Seoul Tiger card (currently a stand-in serif).

7. Technical architecture

STACK

React/Vite client on Firebase Hosting · Supabase (Postgres) backend · Firebase Cloud Functions (Blaze plan) for share OG rendering · OpenAI-powered verdict generation via a Supabase edge function.

VERDICT PIPELINE (PINNED – DO NOT REOPEN)

Gatekeeper **v14** (blocks drug supply, crisis, minor-safety; deliberately allows personal-use transgression) → verdict engine **v45** (deadpan, plain-language). Generation is non-streaming. **[FROM REPO]** exact edge-function name (create_confession / generate-verdict), prompt contents, model + params.

PER-VENUE PROMPTS (LAYER 1 ONLY)

Slug-keyed lookup returns {headline, guidance?}; unknown/missing source → generic default ("Confess something.", no guidance). Merged into the existing venue config (one source of truth per slug — display name AND prompt). Tailored *input* produces tailored *output*; the verdict engine is NOT given venue context (Layer 2 deliberately not built).

METRICS WIRING

`session_id` + `is_test` columns on confessions; `tag_confession()` RPC tags the row after verdict; `log_share()` RPC + `share_events` table log share taps. `?test=1` persists across repeat confessions and clears on a fresh real scan.

SHARE LINKS & PRIVACY (ENUMERATION-PROOF)

- Share URL keyed on the confession's **unguessable UUID** (`public.confessions.id`), never the sequential `subject_number`.
- `resolve_share_id(subject_number, session_id, verdict)` — ownership-gated; hands the confessor their own UUID; cannot be used as a `subject_number`→UUID oracle.
- `get_share_verdict(uuid)` — uuid-only read; a non-uuid ('1','354') matches nothing → 404.
- Firebase functions `ogImage` + `share` serve per-verdict OG tags/image to scrapers; bad/missing id → clean 404 (not 500); real UUID → 200 image/png. Verified live.
- Public wall stays approved-only; a confessor sharing their OWN verdict is not gated on moderation (it's their content, not us publishing it).

[FROM REPO] Exact file names (VerdictShare.tsx, metrics.ts, functions/index.mjs, card.mjs), migration IDs, function URLs, and RPC signatures — pull from Claude Code, don't author from memory.

8. Canonical QR / URL format (LOCKED)

`https://theboothrecord.com/confess?source=<SLUG>&venue=<URL-encoded display name>`

- `source` = per-venue slug — BOTH the attribution key AND the personalization key. Must be identical across QR, Supabase, and every A/B variant, or counts fragment.
- `venue` = URL-encoded display name (spaces = %20).
- **Locked slug registry:** Frenchie = `frenchiecbd` (A/B: `frenchiecbda` / `frenchiecbdb`); Seoul Tiger 1988 = `seoultiger1988`.
- Print QR: error-correction Q, white quiet-zone baked in, on cream/white panel. Always test-scan before a batch (confirm %20 decodes and venue stamps correctly).

9- Open items / roadmap

- **Test data:** everything through subject #477 is Pete's own testing. From launch, all test scans use `?test=1`. Consider a clean wipe so the count starts at true zero. Old bare-slug rows (`seoultiger`, `frenchie`) are dead test data.
- **Streaming verdict:** considered, rejected for now — architecture change + stutter risk on venue wifi outweighs the gain; current loading sequence is adequate.
- **Layer-2 verdict context:** parked — only if real data shows verdicts aren't landing venue-appropriately (evidence contradicts).
- **Client PNG long-verdict overflow:** known bug — the client card clips on very long verdicts (the Satori server render fixed this independently). Consider porting the dynamic sizing to the client card.
- **Housekeeping:** push local commits to origin; SSOT to become a Supabase `venues` table once enough venues (slug, display name, palette, prompt).

The only number that pays the bills is CANS SOLD. Everything the Booth measures is instrumentation in service of that — never the goal.